

Diabetes - Low Blood Sugar - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1072 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Hypoglycemia (low blood sugar) assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Clinical background

- Hypoglycaemia is usually a blood-glucose level below 4 mmol/L and should be treated promptly.
- Symptoms can include hunger, sweating, shaking, dizziness, weakness, visual change, irritability, palpitations, and confusion.
- An unconscious person must not be given food or drink by mouth; emergency escalation depends on recovery and glucagon availability.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, what glucose reading and units are shown, what symptoms are present, and what does their personal diabetes/hypoglycaemia plan say?
2. [YES_NO] Is a glucagon injection available and does someone know how to use it?
3. [YES_NO] Has the person been drinking alcohol?
4. [PREGNANCY] Is the patient pregnant or possibly pregnant? If yes, record gestation where known.

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Diabetes - High Blood Sugar

Is the measured glucose high rather than below 4 mmol/L, with thirst, frequent urination, or other hyperglycaemia symptoms?

NHS.UK distinguishes hyperglycaemia from hypoglycaemia; a high reading belongs in the high-blood-sugar pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is the person unresponsive or unconscious, AND is a glucagon injection unavailable, or has one already been given without recovery within 10 minutes, or has the person been drinking alcohol?

NHS.UK low blood sugar guidance lists these as call-999 criteria for severe hypoglycemia.

1. Disposition level 15

Is the person conscious and able to swallow safely, with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance provides the fast-acting sugar treatment steps for a conscious person with low blood sugar.

Advice

Qatar emergency low-blood-sugar response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for reduced consciousness, seizure, unsafe swallowing, severe confusion/aggression, injury, or failure to improve under the person's approved plan. Give prescribed glucagon only if it is available and the helper is trained, following the product/personal plan. Do not give anything by mouth to a drowsy, seizing, or unsafe-to-swallow person; use the recovery position if breathing. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: no improvement under the prescribed rescue plan; worsening unresponsiveness; seizure or abnormal breathing.

Governed fast-acting carbohydrate treatment

- Only if fully awake and swallowing safely, follow the person's clinician-approved diabetes plan for fast-acting carbohydrate and timed glucose recheck. Product, amount, repeat interval, follow-on food, insulin/pump adjustment, and pediatric/pregnancy actions require the approved Qatar protocol; do not improvise exact doses. Escalate to 999 for deterioration or failure to respond.
- Call Back If: no improvement according to the personal plan; level of consciousness or swallowing worsens; seizure or recurrent episode.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for reduced consciousness, seizure, unsafe swallowing, severe confusion/aggression, injury, or failure to improve under the person's approved plan. Give prescribed glucagon only if it is available and the helper is trained, following the product/personal plan. Do not give anything by mouth to a drowsy, seizing, or unsafe-to-swallow person; use the recovery position if breathing. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Low blood sugar (hypoglycaemia)", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/low-blood-sugar-hypoglycaemia/> (page last reviewed 03 August 2023)

Provenance

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Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect and is not a disposition row. Local disposition mappings and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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